Nicholas Rode

Motion Designer & Engineer

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SUMMARY

Motion designer and engineer with 5+ years of experience shipping motion for B2B SaaS and tech brands. I turn complex products into clear, engaging motion and build it production-ready, fast, and accessible in Rive, Lottie, and code. An AI-first workflow lets me prototype, iterate, and ship faster, and I build my own tools to close the gap between design and development.

EXPERIENCE

Motion Engineer, Webstacks Jan 2025 – Present

B2B web design and development agency · Promoted from Motion Designer, Oct 2026

- Shipped interactive motion, animation, and illustration for Gong and Fireworks AI, including product UI motion for Fireworks AI
- Built 4 interactive Rive product demos for Deepgram's AI voice platform: voice-to-text, voice avatars, assistant states, and a Slack integration walkthrough
- Designed a 10-piece Rive motion system for Shep's rebrand and raised the hero's Lighthouse score from 40 to 99 by switching its Rive runtime from WebGL2 to Canvas
- Built AI-powered internal tools with Claude Code: a pipeline that turns After Effects renders into lightweight WebGL shaders and a Figma plugin that generates reliable React code
- Use AI daily to prototype interactions and write production animation code, speeding up design-to-dev handoff
- Choose and optimize animation runtimes for mobile web performance

Junior Designer (Product UI & Motion), Variable Medium Jan 2021 – Dec 2024

- Designed the desktop and mobile peer-to-peer trading app for Evaluate, from interactive prototypes for user testing through launch, plus its marketing site and onboarding video
- Designed trade and chat flows, including asynchronous offers with expiry dates so traders don't need to be online at the same time
- Contributed to design system development and created motion that clarified complex product flows

Freelance Motion Designer & Illustrator, Self-employed 2022 – Present

- Deliver motion graphics, illustration, and web and mobile design for tech, SaaS, and B2B clients

TOOLS I'VE BUILT

Stroke Center (Figma Community): Plugin that converts inside/outside strokes to center for clean Lottie export.

Design to Webpage: AI skill that turns Figma designs into working HTML prototypes with interactions and motion; used on client projects.

SKILLS

Motion & interaction: Rive (state machines, interactive components), After Effects, Lottie/Bodymovin, UI animation, micro-interactions, transitions, motion systems, visual storytelling, 2D/3D animation

Design: Figma (including motion), Illustrator, UI/UX design, design systems, interactive prototyping

Production & performance: Rive web runtimes (React, Canvas, WebGL2), Lottie JSON delivery, WebGL shaders, Lighthouse performance tuning, reduced-motion accessibility, developer handoff

AI workflow: Claude Code, AI-assisted prototyping and production code, Figma plugin and AI tool development

EDUCATION

Art Institute of Seattle

Nucamp, Full Stack Web Design 2020

COURSES

Rive Masterclass

TheMotionMagic, Ultimate Rive Animation Course

School of Motion, A Motion Design Masterpiece